



CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Product Management for Professionals

Discovery, prioritization, roadmaps, PRDs, metrics, experiments, and stakeholder execution

PARTNER LEARNING SERIES

Learn how professional product managers turn ambiguous customer needs into testable product decisions, coordinated delivery, measurable outcomes, and continuous learning.

CareerSense Partners • analysts • designers • engineers • aspiring product managers

CareerSense Learning Series • careersenseai.com/resources

FRONT MATTER

How to Use This Handbook

Learn how professional product managers turn ambiguous customer needs into testable product decisions, coordinated delivery, measurable outcomes, and continuous learning.

What each chapter contains

Each chapter follows the same learning rhythm used across the CareerSense Academy series: a concise introduction, learning objectives, plain-English concepts, CareerSense examples, professional habits, common mistakes, quick revision notes, practice questions, and hands-on exercises.

PARTNER PROMISE The examples are designed to prepare you for real CareerSense Partner assignments. Do not memorize terminology. Learn to create useful work products: audits, reports, prototypes, dashboards, campaigns, strategies, and decisions.

Recommended practice approach

- Read the relevant chapter before starting the matching Partner assignment.
- Use CareerSense or a safe sample environment to practise whenever possible.
- Keep evidence: screenshots, notes, links, spreadsheets, queries, designs, or metrics.
- Document assumptions and limitations instead of hiding uncertainty.
- Finish each chapter by completing at least one hands-on exercise.

CONTENTS

What You Will Learn

Chapter	Topic
01	Product Thinking and Outcomes
02	Customer Discovery and Jobs-to-be-Done
03	Problem Framing and Opportunity Mapping
04	Prioritization and Roadmaps
05	PRDs, User Stories, and Acceptance Criteria
06	Working with Design and Engineering
07	Product Metrics and Experimentation
08	CareerSense Capstone: Write a Product Proposal

Closing the book: quick revision sheet • glossary • professional habits • 20-question quiz • answer key • next steps.

CHAPTER 01

01

Product Thinking and Outcomes

Product management coordinates customer value, business value, usability, feasibility, and viability. Shipping features is an output; changing user behavior or business results is an outcome.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define product management
- Distinguish outputs from outcomes
- Recognize product risks
- Connect strategy to execution

Core idea

Product management coordinates customer value, business value, usability, feasibility, and viability. Shipping features is an output; changing user behavior or business results is an outcome.

Professional perspective

Every product idea carries value risk, usability risk, feasibility risk, and business risk.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A CareerSense feature is successful when it improves a meaningful user or business outcome, not merely because it was released.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Define product management.
- Distinguish outputs from outcomes.
- Recognize product risks.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of product thinking and outcomes?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to product thinking and outcomes using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 02

02

Customer Discovery and Jobs-to-be-Done

Discovery aims to reduce uncertainty before expensive delivery. Strong interviews focus on real past behavior, triggers, workarounds, constraints, and consequences.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Plan discovery interviews
- Identify user jobs and pains
- Avoid leading questions
- Synthesize evidence

Core idea

Discovery aims to reduce uncertainty before expensive delivery. Strong interviews focus on real past behavior, triggers, workarounds, constraints, and consequences.

Professional perspective

Jobs-to-be-done thinking asks what progress a user is trying to make in a specific situation.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Instead of asking 'Would you use an AI resume coach?', ask job seekers what happened the last time they prepared a resume and how they knew it was good enough.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Plan discovery interviews.
- Identify user jobs and pains.
- Avoid leading questions.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of customer discovery and jobs-to-be-done?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to customer discovery and jobs-to-be-done using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 03

03

Problem Framing and Opportunity Mapping

Teams often jump from a complaint directly to a feature. Product professionals first clarify who has the problem, how often, how severe it is, and how solving it connects to strategy.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Write opportunity statements
- Build assumption maps
- Prioritize problems before solutions
- Create opportunity solution trees

Core idea

Teams often jump from a complaint directly to a feature. Product professionals first clarify who has the problem, how often, how severe it is, and how solving it connects to strategy.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

If users abandon ATS analysis, investigate trust, comprehension, latency, cost, and next-action clarity before redesigning the score.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Write opportunity statements.
- Build assumption maps.
- Prioritize problems before solutions.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of problem framing and opportunity mapping?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to problem framing and opportunity mapping using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 04

04

Prioritization and Roadmaps

Prioritization is resource allocation under uncertainty. Scores help expose assumptions but do not replace strategy.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Use RICE and impact-effort
- Recognize dependencies
- Create outcome-based roadmaps
- Communicate trade-offs

Core idea

Prioritization is resource allocation under uncertainty. Scores help expose assumptions but do not replace strategy.

Professional perspective

Outcome roadmaps communicate what change matters and why, while leaving room to discover the best solution.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A CareerSense roadmap can prioritize 'increase completed interview simulations' instead of committing prematurely to a specific reminder feature.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Use RICE and impact-effort.
- Recognize dependencies.
- Create outcome-based roadmaps.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of prioritization and roadmaps?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to prioritization and roadmaps using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 05

05

PRDs, User Stories, and Acceptance Criteria

A useful PRD establishes context, problem, users, goals, non-goals, scope, flows, metrics, constraints, dependencies, risks, and open questions.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Write concise PRDs
- Create user stories
- Define acceptance criteria
- Clarify non-functional requirements

Core idea

A useful PRD establishes context, problem, users, goals, non-goals, scope, flows, metrics, constraints, dependencies, risks, and open questions.

Professional perspective

Acceptance criteria make expected behavior testable.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

For a certificate verification feature, specify verification states, invalid links, privacy rules, loading behavior, and mobile response.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Write concise PRDs.
- Create user stories.
- Define acceptance criteria.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of prds, user stories, and acceptance criteria?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to prds, user stories, and acceptance criteria using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 06

06

Working with Design and Engineering

Product managers do not 'throw requirements over the wall'. They collaborate continuously with design and engineering as constraints and insights emerge.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Run effective handoffs
- Manage scope changes
- Use prototypes to reduce ambiguity
- Participate in release readiness

Core idea

Product managers do not 'throw requirements over the wall'. They collaborate continuously with design and engineering as constraints and insights emerge.

Professional perspective

Good scope decisions protect the core outcome while reducing unnecessary complexity.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A Partner redesigning CareerSense should explain the user problem and acceptance criteria, not only submit screenshots.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Run effective handoffs.
- Manage scope changes.
- Use prototypes to reduce ambiguity.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of working with design and engineering?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to working with design and engineering using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 07

07

Product Metrics and Experimentation

Metrics should reflect the behavioral change a product is intended to create. Guardrail metrics protect against unintended harm.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define north-star and guardrail metrics
- Build funnels
- Use cohort thinking
- Design experiments

Core idea

Metrics should reflect the behavioral change a product is intended to create. Guardrail metrics protect against unintended harm.

Professional perspective

Experiments need a clear hypothesis, target population, intervention, primary metric, duration, and decision rule.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

An onboarding experiment could optimize profile completion while monitoring support requests and abandonment.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Define north-star and guardrail metrics.
- Build funnels.
- Use cohort thinking.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of product metrics and experimentation?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to product metrics and experimentation using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 08

08

CareerSense Capstone: Write a Product Proposal

Choose one CareerSense workflow. Document the current journey, user evidence, opportunity, proposed MVP, acceptance criteria, risks, launch plan, and success metrics.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Create discovery evidence
- Prioritize an opportunity
- Write a PRD
- Design launch metrics

Core idea

Choose one CareerSense workflow. Document the current journey, user evidence, opportunity, proposed MVP, acceptance criteria, risks, launch plan, and success metrics.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Deliver a professional 4-6 page product proposal suitable for review by design, engineering, and leadership.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Create discovery evidence.
- Prioritize an opportunity.
- Write a PRD.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of careersense capstone: write a product proposal?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to careersense capstone: write a product proposal using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CLOSING THE BOOK

Course Summary

You have worked through the professional foundations of product management for professionals. The purpose of this handbook is not to make you fluent in vocabulary; it is to help you complete real work with stronger judgment, structure, evidence, and communication.

**PROFESSIONAL
TAKEAWAY**

CareerSense Partners should be able to explain not only what they did, but why it mattered, what evidence supported it, what trade-offs existed, and what measurable action should happen next.

Product Management for Professionals - Quick Revision Sheet

Topic	Remember
Product Thinking and Outcomes	Define product management
Customer Discovery and Jobs-to-be-Done	Plan discovery interviews
Problem Framing and Opportunity Mapping	Write opportunity statements
Prioritization and Roadmaps	Use RICE and impact-effort
PRDs, User Stories, and Acceptance Criteria	Write concise PRDs
Working with Design and Engineering	Run effective handoffs
Product Metrics and Experimentation	Define north-star and guardrail metrics
CareerSense Capstone: Write a Product Proposal	Create discovery evidence

Glossary

Term	Plain-English meaning
PRD	Product Requirements Document describing problem, scope, behavior, and success.
Acceptance criteria	Testable conditions that define expected behavior.
Roadmap	A prioritized view of intended outcomes and initiatives over time.
Outcome	A measurable change in user, customer, or business behavior.
Metric	A quantitative measure used to monitor performance or progress.
Hypothesis	A testable statement about what change is expected and why.
Stakeholder	A person or group affected by or able to influence an initiative.
MVP	The smallest trustworthy version that tests an important assumption.
KPI	A key performance indicator tied to an important objective.
Iteration	A cycle of building, measuring, learning, and improving.
Trade-off	Choosing one benefit or priority while accepting a cost elsewhere.
Evidence	Observed information that supports or challenges a decision.
Prioritization	Deciding what deserves attention and resources first.

20-Question Practice Quiz

1. What is one core principle from 'Product Thinking and Outcomes'?
9. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Product Thinking and Outcomes' in a real assignment?
2. What is one core principle from 'Customer Discovery and Jobs-to-be-Done'?
10. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Customer Discovery and Jobs-to-be-Done' in a real assignment?
3. What is one core principle from 'Problem Framing and Opportunity Mapping'?
11. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Problem Framing and Opportunity Mapping' in a real assignment?
4. What is one core principle from 'Prioritization and Roadmaps'?
12. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Prioritization and Roadmaps' in a real assignment?
5. What is one core principle from 'PRDs, User Stories, and Acceptance Criteria'?
13. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'PRDs, User Stories, and Acceptance Criteria' in a real assignment?
6. What is one core principle from 'Working with Design and Engineering'?
14. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Working with Design and Engineering' in a real assignment?
7. What is one core principle from 'Product Metrics and Experimentation'?
15. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Product Metrics and Experimentation' in a real assignment?
8. What is one core principle from 'CareerSense Capstone: Write a Product Proposal'?
16. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'CareerSense Capstone: Write a Product Proposal' in a real assignment?
17. Why should recommendations be tied to evidence?
18. What is the difference between an activity and an outcome?
19. Why should assumptions and limitations be documented?
20. What makes an assignment deliverable useful to leadership?

Answer Key

1. A strong answer should explain define product management and connect it to an observable decision or result.
9. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
2. A strong answer should explain plan discovery interviews and connect it to an observable decision or result.
10. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
3. A strong answer should explain write opportunity statements and connect it to an observable decision or result.
11. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
4. A strong answer should explain use rice and impact-effort and connect it to an observable decision or result.
12. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
5. A strong answer should explain write concise prds and connect it to an observable decision or result.
13. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
6. A strong answer should explain run effective handoffs and connect it to an observable decision or result.
14. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
7. A strong answer should explain define north-star and guardrail metrics and connect it to an observable decision or result.
15. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
8. A strong answer should explain create discovery evidence and connect it to an observable decision or result.
16. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
17. Evidence separates a useful recommendation from an unsupported opinion.
18. An activity is work performed; an outcome is the change produced by that work.
19. Documenting assumptions makes uncertainty visible and allows reviewers to judge the strength of the conclusion.
20. A useful deliverable is clear, evidence-based, actionable, appropriately scoped, and tied to an owner or next decision.

CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Keep Building

You now have a working foundation in product management for professionals. Use this handbook as a reference before and during your Partner assignments. Professional capability grows when you repeatedly turn concepts into useful outputs, receive feedback, and improve your judgment.

NEXT STEPS

- Choose the CareerSense Partner assignment most closely related to this handbook.
- Review the relevant chapter before beginning.
- Complete the assignment with traceable evidence.
- Ask for feedback on both the result and your decision process.
- Add the finished work to your Partner portfolio where permitted.

**CAREERSENSE
PARTNER
LEARNING PATH**

Learn → Apply → Document → Review → Improve → Lead.

More CareerSense learning resources

careersenseai.com/resources